

ADMIN MANUAL

THE GYM TX MEALS · GTXMEALS.COM

How to run the weekly menu, orders, prep, labels and customer messages
October 2026

CONTENTS

1. Getting started
Signing in and the admin menu

2. The week at a glance
What happens automatically, and when

3. Builder: ordering, ready date and texting
Opening/closing ordering, holiday weeks

4. Builder: meals
Adding, editing, hiding meals; staple vs. rotating

5. Builder: add-ons (customizations)
Choosing which customizations each meal offers

6. Builder: extras & sauces

7. Orders
Order statuses, recording payments, cancelling, Export to Excel

8. Prep list and labels
What to cook, and printing labels on R011 sheets

9. Customers
Editing customers, pickup locations, reminders

10. Menu flyers
Weekly and monthly menus, PDFs and sending them out

11. Automatic emails and texts
Everything customers and you receive

12. Alerts and the monthly budget

13. Troubleshooting

1. GETTING STARTED

SIGNING IN

1. Go to **gtxmeals.com** and click **Log in / Sign up**.
2. Sign in with the admin account (**gtxmeals@gmail.com**).
3. The menu bar switches to the admin menu.



The admin menu bar

Menu item	What it's for
Menu	The customer menu, as customers see it (read-only for you), plus links to the weekly and monthly menu flyers.
Builder	Ordering on/off, the ready (pickup) date, texting, and the meals, add-ons and extras on the menu.
Orders	Every order, its status, and Export to Excel.
Prep List	How many of each meal and customization to cook, and label printing.
Customers	Customer accounts, pickup locations, and the "send weekly reminders" button.
Manual	Opens this manual in a new tab.
Log out	Signs out of the admin account.

> **Tip:** The admin pages are designed for a computer screen (laptop or desktop). Customers can use any phone.

> **Important:** The admin account can't place orders. To test ordering, sign in with a separate customer account.

2. THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

Most of the week runs itself. All times are Central.

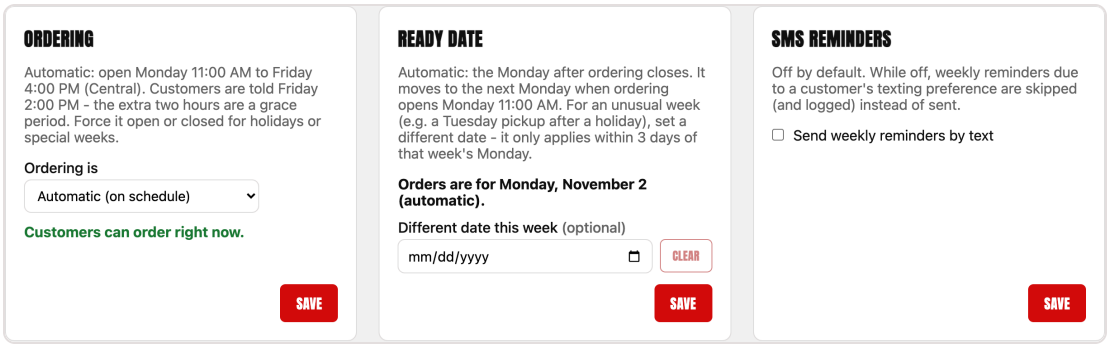
When	What happens	Who does it
Monday 11:00 AM	Ordering opens for the **next** Monday's pickup. The ready date moves forward a week.	Automatic
Any time an order changes	The customer gets a confirmation, "updated" or "canceled" email. You get a matching email at gtxmeals@gmail.com.	Automatic
Thursday 6:00 PM	Reminder to customers who haven't ordered yet (and haven't unsubscribed). Skipped if you've closed ordering.	Automatic
Friday 2:00 PM	The deadline customers are told. After it, they can't edit or cancel online.	—
Friday 4:00 PM	Ordering actually closes (a quiet two-hour grace period).	Automatic
Saturday 9:00 AM	You get an **"Unpaid Orders for Monday..."** email listing every order not yet **marked** as fully paid, with the amount due. Mark early-morning payments before 9 so they're left off. Nothing is cancelled automatically.	Automatic
Saturday morning	Follow up on the unpaid list. Cancel an order only if you decide to (Orders page; the customer is emailed).	You
Saturday/Sunday	Use the Prep List to shop and cook; print labels.	You
Pickup day 7:00 AM	"Your meals are ready" reminder to everyone with an order for that day.	Automatic
Pickup day	Mark orders **delivered** as they're picked up (optional, but keeps the Orders page tidy).	You

YOUR WEEKLY CHECKLIST

1. **Before Monday 11 AM:** make sure next week's rotating meals are in the Builder with the right ready date, and their customizations are filled in.
2. **Monday:** optionally send the weekly menu flyer to customers (Menu flyers, chapter 10).
3. **As payments arrive:** record them in the Payment column on the Orders page.
4. **Saturday:** check the unpaid orders email; follow up, record payments, or cancel if needed.
5. **Prep day:** Prep List → print labels → cook → label.
6. **Pickup day:** mark orders delivered.

3. BUILDER: ORDERING, READY DATE AND TEXTING

The three cards at the top of the **Builder** page.



ORDERING

- **Automatic (on schedule)** — the normal setting. Open Monday 11:00 AM to Friday 4:00 PM.
- **Forced open** — opens ordering outside the schedule (e.g. you want to take a late order).
- **Forced closed** — closes ordering, e.g. a holiday week or when you're full. Customers see an "Ordering Is Currently Closed" message and the Thursday reminder isn't sent.

The line under the menu (e.g. *"Customers can order right now."*) tells you the current state. Click **Save** after changing it.

> **Remember:** after a forced open/closed week, set it back to **Automatic**.

READY DATE

The pickup date for orders being placed now. It's automatic: the Monday after ordering closes.

For an unusual week (e.g. a **Tuesday** pickup after a holiday), pick the date under **Different date this week** and click **Save**. It only applies within 3 days of that week's Monday, so it can't accidentally carry over to later weeks. **Clear** goes back to automatic.

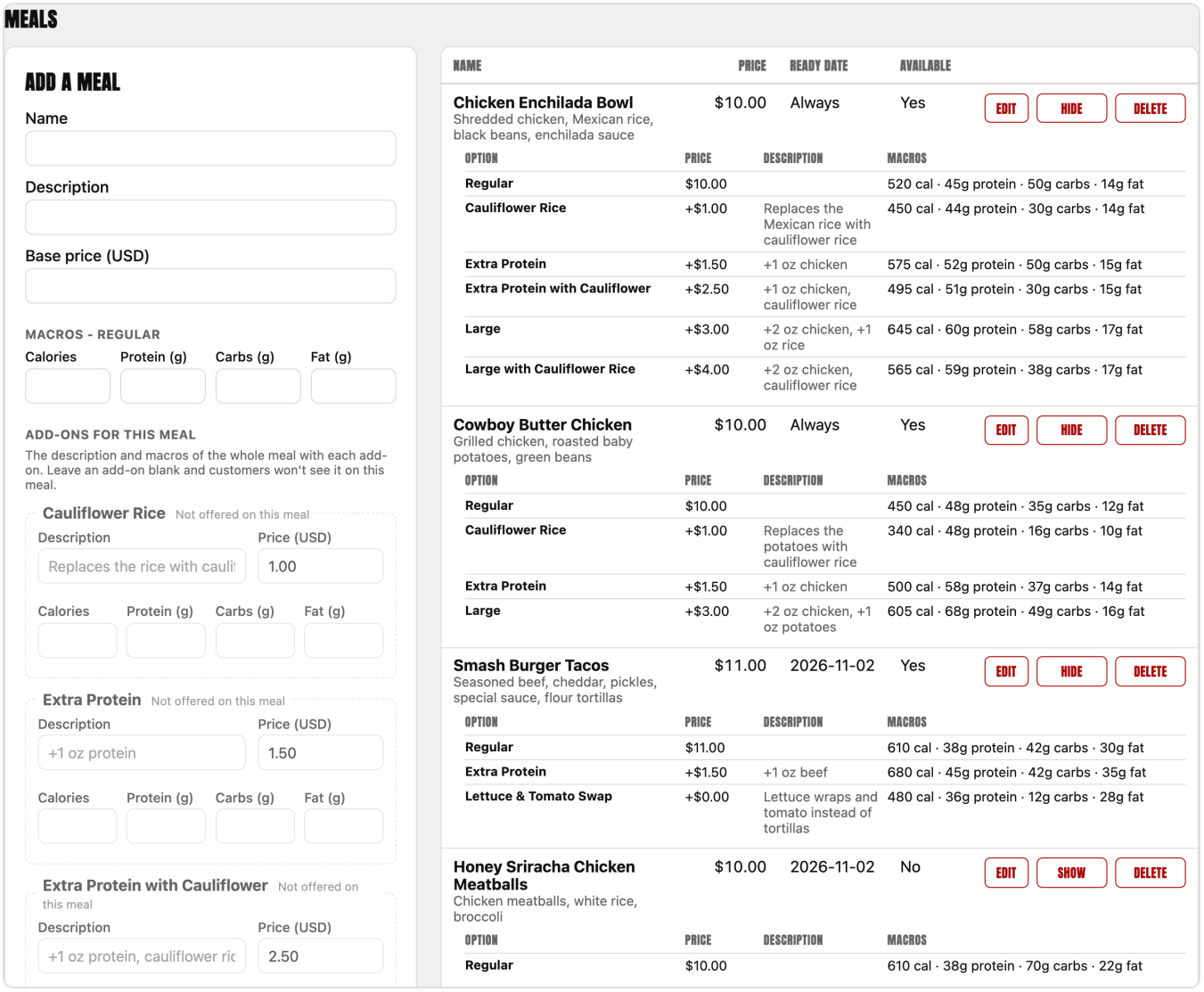
Customer emails use the real date, so a Tuesday pickup reads "Pickup Date: Tuesday, ..." and the pickup reminder goes out Tuesday morning.

SMS REMINDERS (TEXTING)

Off. Texting needs a Twilio account to be set up first (ask your developer). While it's off:

- The **automatic** messages (order emails, Thursday and pickup-day reminders) go by email to customers who prefer texts, so they don't miss them.
- The manual **Send weekly reminders** and flyer **Send** buttons **skip** customers who prefer texts, and report how many were skipped.

4. BUILDER: MEALS



Add a meal (left) and the meals on the menu (right), with each meal's options underneath

ADDING A MEAL

1. Fill in **Name**, **Description** and **Base price**.
2. Enter the regular meal's macros (calories, protein, carbs, fat).
3. Under **Add-ons for this meal**, fill in only the customizations this meal offers (see chapter 5).
4. Under **Availability**, either tick **Staple (always on the menu)**, **or** pick the ready date it's offered for (a rotating meal).
5. Click **Add meal**.

STAPLE VS. ROTATING

Type	On the menu	Shown with
Staple	Every week.	⭐ star
Rotating	Only for the ready date you picked.	🔄 arrows

The star or arrows appear automatically from this setting — don't type them into the meal name.

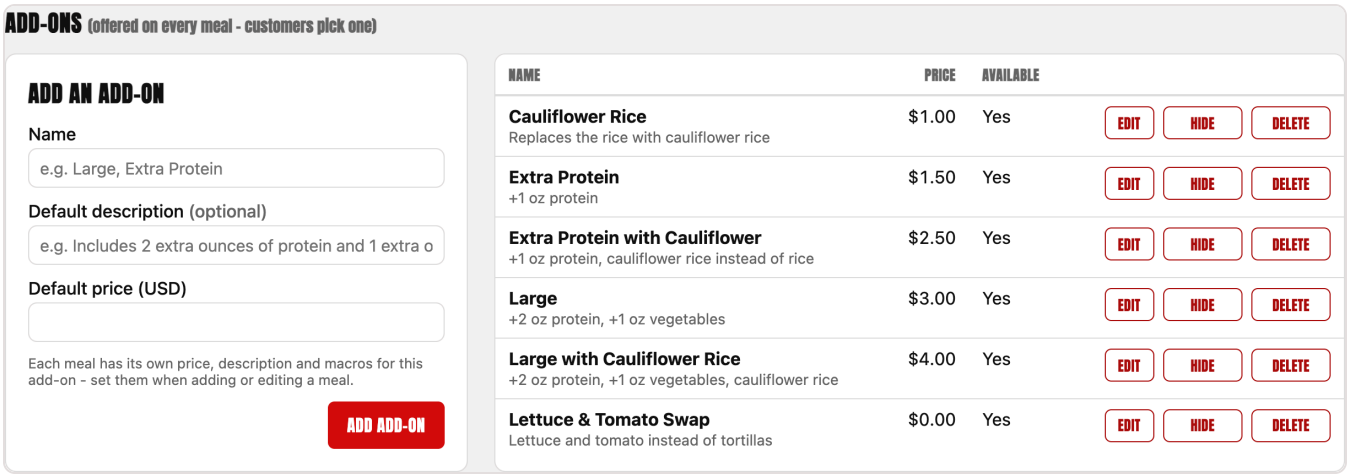
EDITING, HIDING AND DELETING

- **Edit** opens the meal for changes. Saving doesn't change orders already placed.
- **Hide** takes a meal off the menu without deleting it (the list shows **Available: No**). **Show** puts it back.
- **Delete** removes it for good. Past orders keep their copy of it.

> **Tip:** Remove test meals (like "Tester") before their week opens — customers will see any meal that's available for the current ready date.

5. BUILDER: ADD-ONS (CUSTOMIZATIONS)

Add-ons are the options a customer can pick for a meal — one per meal — such as *Cauliflower Rice*, *Extra Protein*, *Large* or *Large with Cauliflower Rice*. Combinations are add-ons of their own.



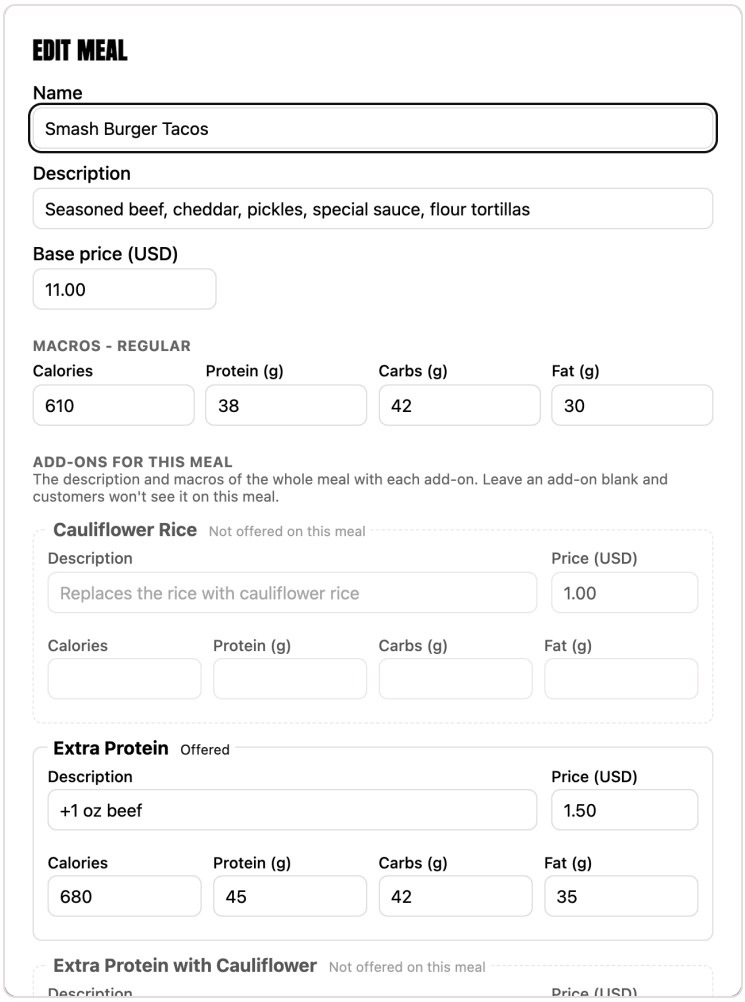
The list of add-ons

CREATING AN ADD-ON

Give it a **Name**, an optional **Default description**, and a **Default price**, then click **Add add-on**. A new add-on isn't offered on any meal until you fill it in on that meal.

CHOOSING WHICH CUSTOMIZATIONS EACH MEAL OFFERS

In **Edit** (or Add a meal) every add-on has a box. **A customization is offered on a meal only if you fill in its description or its macros for that meal.** Leave a box blank and customers won't see that option on that meal.



Each box says **Offered** or **Not offered on this meal** as you type

- The grey text in an empty description is just the add-on's default, as a hint — it isn't saved unless you type it.
- Macros are for the **whole meal** with that customization (not just the extra part).
- The price starts at the add-on's default; change it for this meal if needed.

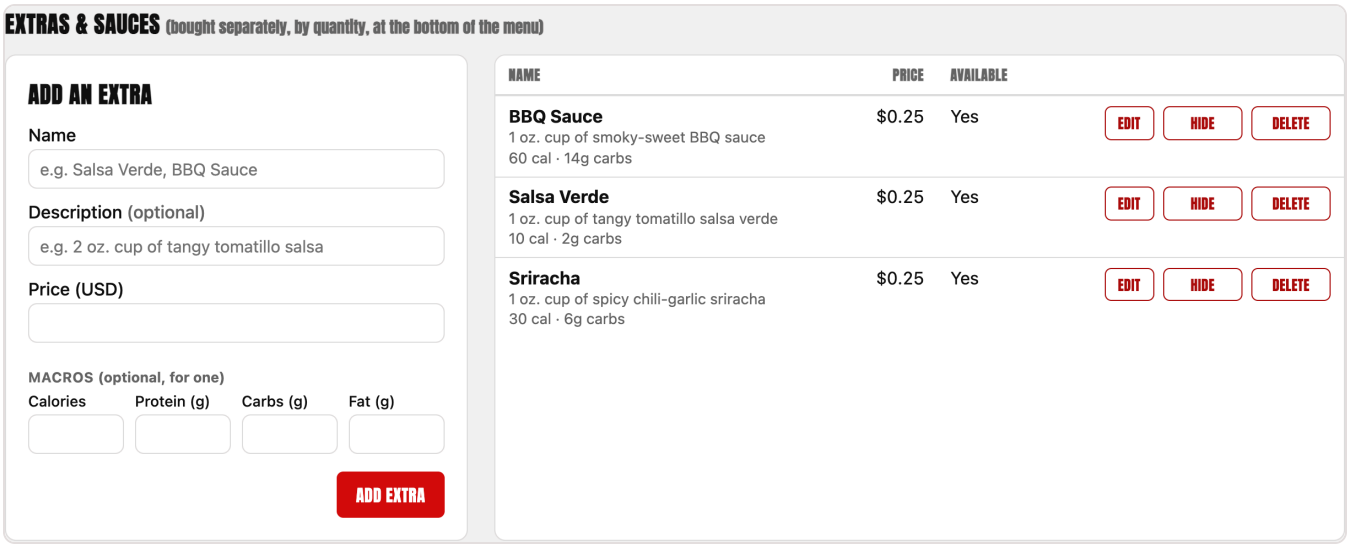
> **Example — Smash Burger Tacos:** create a "Lettuce & Tomato Swap" add-on. On the tacos, fill in the swap and leave the cauliflower rice boxes blank. The swap shows only on the tacos; cauliflower rice stays on every other meal that has it filled in.

HIDING AND DELETING AN ADD-ON

- **Hide** stops offering it on every meal, but keeps it for later.
- **Delete** removes it from the list (to avoid clutter). Meals keep their own copy, shown as "(deleted)" in the meals list; customers can't pick it.

6. BUILDER: EXTRAS & SAUCES

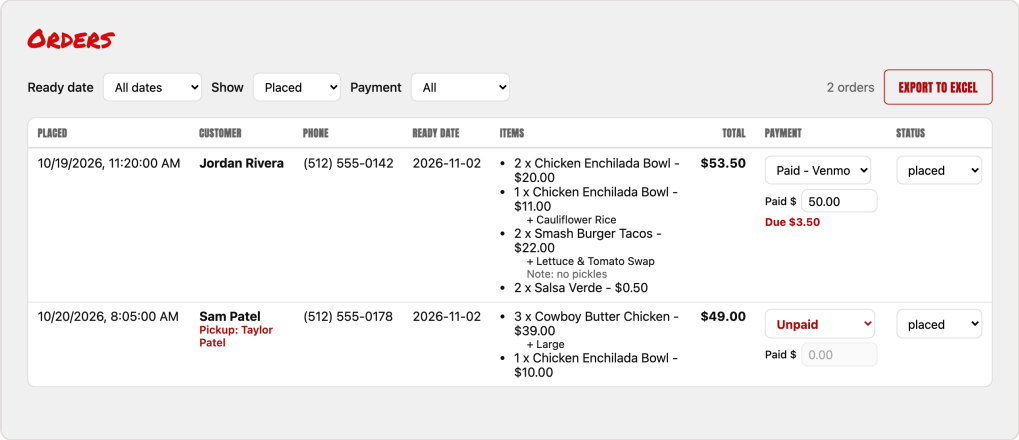
Extras (e.g. Salsa Verde, BBQ Sauce, Sriracha — $0.25 each) are bought by quantity at the bottom of the menu, on top of at least one meal.



- Add one with a name, price, and optionally a description and macros (for one).
- The description and macros show wherever the extra appears: the menu, the cart, My Orders, Orders and the Prep List.
- **Hide**, **Edit** and **Delete** work like add-ons.

The current macros are estimates for a 1 oz. cup. Update them if your cups or recipes differ.

7. ORDERS



FINDING ORDERS

- **Ready date** — one pickup date, or all dates.
- **Show** — Placed (default), Prepared, Delivered, Cancelled, or All.
- **Payment** — All, or **Unpaid only**.
- Each order shows the customer, the person picking up (if someone else), phone, items with customizations, notes and extras, and the total.

ORDER STATUS

Status	Meaning
placed	New order. The customer can still edit or cancel it until Friday 2:00 PM.
prepared	Cooked and labeled.
delivered	Picked up.
cancelled	Cancelled by the customer or by you. Not counted on the Prep List.

Change the status with the drop-down on the right.

RECORDING PAYMENTS

Checkout doesn't take payment, so every order starts as **Unpaid** (shown in red). When a customer pays, pick **Paid - Venmo**, **Paid - Cash** or **Free** in the order's **Payment** drop-down — it saves right away.

- **Paid $** starts at the order total when you pick Venmo or cash. If they paid a different amount, type it and press Enter.
- Under it, **Due $...** (red) is what's still owed; **Refund $...** is what to give back.
- Payment is separate from status, and only you can change it. Customers see it on My Orders (e.g. "Paid $20.00 (Venmo) - $5.00 still due").

WHEN A PAID CUSTOMER EDITS OR CANCELS

- **Edit, new total higher:** their "Updated" email asks them to send the difference.
- **Edit, new total lower:** their email says the difference will be refunded, and you get a separate **"Refund Needed: $… for <name>"** email.
- **Cancelled** (by them or by you): their email says their payment will be refunded, and you get the Refund Needed email.
- After you refund, change **Paid $** to match, so the balance clears.

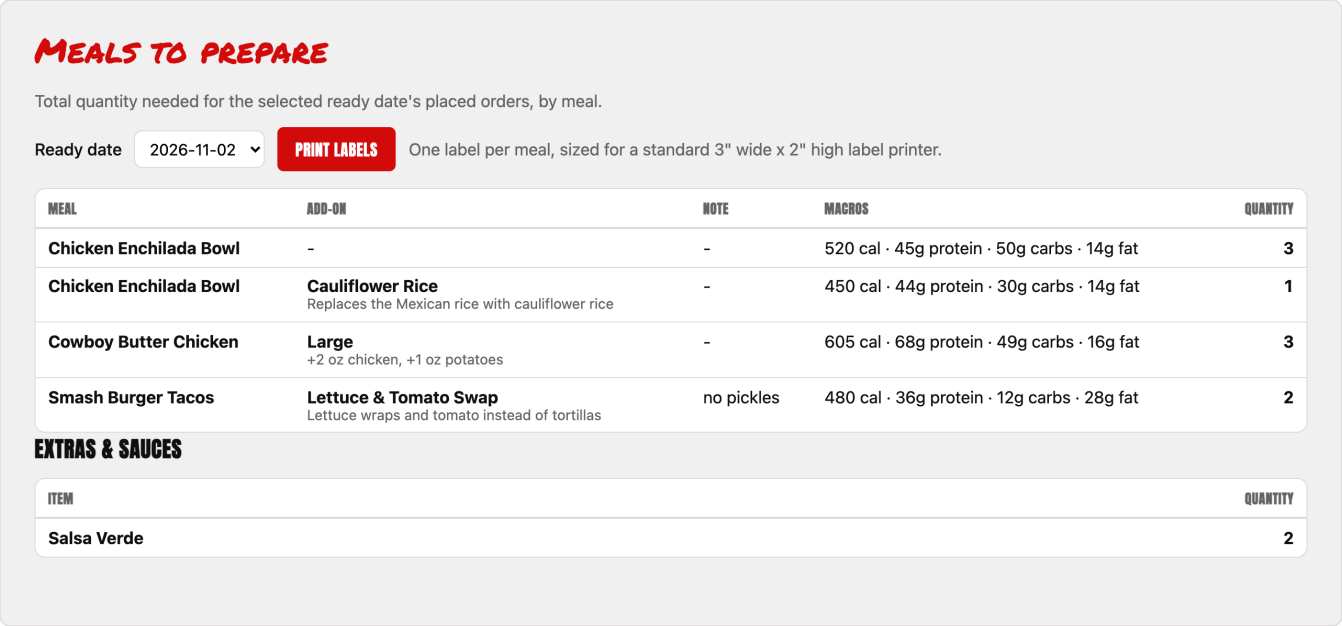
> **Cancelling emails the customer.** Picking **cancelled** asks you to confirm first (**Cancel order** or **Keep order**). Once confirmed, the customer gets the "Your Order Has Been Canceled" email, and if they'd paid you get a Refund Needed email. Other status changes save right away and send nothing.

EXPORT TO EXCEL

Click **Export to Excel** to download the orders currently shown (so set the filters first). The file opens in Excel, or use File → Import in Google Sheets.

Columns: Placed · Customer · Email · Phone · Pickup Location · Picked up by · Ready date · Status · for each meal: its quantity and its customizations (e.g. "2 Regular, 1 Large") · Extras & Sauces · Special Requests · Meals · Total ($) · Payment · Amount Paid ($) · Balance ($) (positive = still owed, negative = to refund) · Meal Suggestions. A **Totals** row at the bottom adds up each meal, the meal count and the money. Cancelled orders are left out of the meal counts and Total, but their refunds still count in Balance.

8. PREP LIST AND LABELS



Meals to prepare

Total quantity needed for the selected ready date's placed orders, by meal.

Ready date 2026-11-02 PRINT LABELS One label per meal, sized for a standard 3" wide x 2" high label printer.

MEAL	ADD-ON	NOTE	MACROS	QUANTITY
Chicken Enchilada Bowl	-	-	520 cal · 45g protein · 50g carbs · 14g fat	**3**
Chicken Enchilada Bowl	**Cauliflower Rice** Replaces the Mexican rice with cauliflower rice	-	450 cal · 44g protein · 30g carbs · 14g fat	**1**
Cowboy Butter Chicken	**Large** +2 oz chicken, +1 oz potatoes	-	605 cal · 68g protein · 49g carbs · 16g fat	**3**
Smash Burger Tacos	**Lettuce & Tomato Swap** Lettuce wraps and tomato instead of tortillas	no pickles	480 cal · 36g protein · 12g carbs · 28g fat	**2**

EXTRAS & SAUCES

ITEM	QUANTITY
Salsa Verde	**2**

- Pick the **Ready date**. The table totals every **placed** order for that date, grouped by meal, customization and note.
- The **Extras & Sauces** table totals the sauce cups to portion.

PRINTING LABELS

Labels are made for **SpartanIndustrial R011** sheets: 3" × 2" labels, 10 per letter-size sheet. There's one label per meal container, with the meal, the customer (and who's picking up), macros, the customization, any note, and the allergen statement.

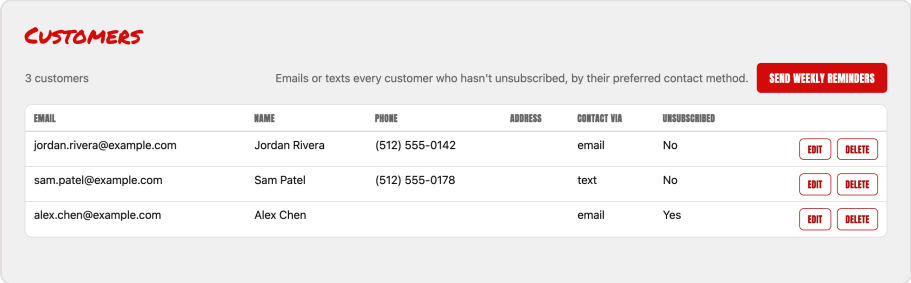
1. Pick the ready date, then click **Print labels**.
2. In the print window (Chrome is recommended): **Scale 100%** (or "Actual size"/"Default"), **Margins: Default**, **Headers and footers: off**.
3. The first time, print one sheet on **plain paper** and hold it against a label sheet to check the alignment.
4. Load the label sheets and print.



A label sheet (sample data)

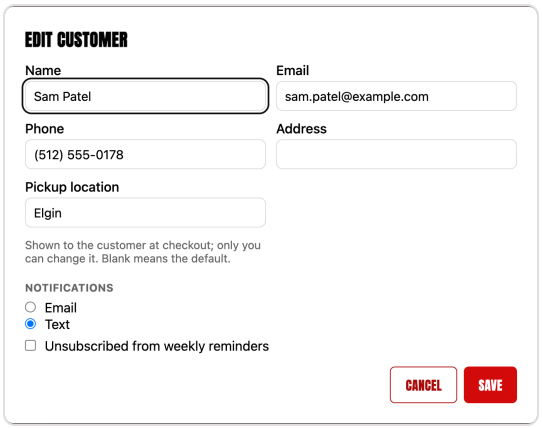
- **Label order:** grouped by meal (A–Z), then customization (Regular first), then note, then customer — so containers come off the printer in plating order.
- Long text shrinks automatically to fit the label.
- Labels only print for the selected ready date.

9. CUSTOMERS



EDITING A CUSTOMER

Click **Edit** on a customer.



- **Name, email, phone, address** — their contact details. Emails go to this address.
- **Pickup location** — only you can set this (customers see it at checkout but can't change it). Leave it blank for the normal Georgetown pickup at The Gym TX. Enter something like *"Elgin"* — or more detail, e.g. *"Elgin – 123 Main St, 5–6 PM"* — and that text replaces the Georgetown address in their emails, at checkout and in the Excel export.
- **Notifications** — email or text (texts need texting switched on; until then their automatic messages come by email).
- **Unsubscribed** — stops reminders and menu announcements (order emails still go out). Customers can also unsubscribe from the link in any reminder.

DELETING A CUSTOMER

Delete removes their login and saved details. Their past orders are kept.

SEND WEEKLY REMINDERS (BUTTON)

Sends a short "This week's menu is up" message to every subscribed customer now (texting customers are skipped while texting is off). The Thursday reminder is automatic; this is for an extra nudge.

10. MENU FLYERS

From the **Menu** page, use **View this week's menu** or **View this month's menu**.



The weekly menu flyer (with macros). The monthly one lists the month's meals without macros.

- **View as PDF** — opens the print window; choose "Save as PDF" to post or share it.
- **Send this menu to customers** — previews the message (a link to the flyer) and how many customers it'll go to; **Send** emails (or texts) every subscribed customer. While texting is off, customers who prefer texts are skipped.
- The QR code links to the menu — handy on a printed flyer at the gym.

11. AUTOMATIC EMAILS AND TEXTS

TO CUSTOMERS

Message	When	Notes
Thank You for Your Order!	Right after they order	Their meals, customizations, notes, extras, total, pickup date and location, and payment reminder (Venmo @lgraffeo88).
Your Order Has Been Updated!	When they save an edited order	The new order and total. Starting an edit doesn't send a cancellation.
Your Order Has Been Canceled	When they cancel, or you set the order to cancelled	What was cancelled, and to email gtxmeals@gmail.com if they've paid.
Don't Forget to Order Your Meals!	Thursday 6:00 PM	Only customers who haven't ordered for this week and haven't unsubscribed. Skipped when ordering is forced closed.
Your Meals Are Ready for Pickup!	7:00 AM on pickup day	Only customers with an order for that day. Shows their pickup location.

- Messages greet customers by first name.
- Customers with no pickup location get the Georgetown address and hours (8:00 AM–1:00 PM or 3:30–6:30 PM); others get their own location and "Please follow your confirmed pickup instructions."
- Replies go to gtxmeals@gmail.com.
- Nobody gets the same reminder twice, even if a send is retried.

TO YOU (GTXMEALS@GMAIL.COM)

- **New Meal Order Received!**, **Meal Order Updated**, **Meal Order Cancelled** — when a customer places, edits or cancels. Includes the customer, items, total, amount paid and balance, phone, pickup location, who's picking up and any meal suggestions.
- **Refund Needed: $... for <name>** — when a paid order is cancelled or edited to cost less.
- **Unpaid Orders for Monday, ...** — Saturday 9:00 AM: each order for the coming pickup that isn't fully paid, with what's due and their phone. If everything's paid you get **All Orders Paid** instead.
- You aren't emailed for changes you make yourself.

> **Changing the wording:** the address, hours, Venmo handle and sign-off are kept in one place in the app — ask your developer to update them.

12. ALERTS AND THE MONTHLY BUDGET

ALERT EMAILS

The site watches itself. If something goes wrong you'll get an email from **GTX Meals Alerts <alerts@gtxmeals.com>**, and another when it's fixed.

Alert	What it means / what to do
The website is down / The API is down	The site or ordering didn't respond for 30 minutes (checked every 15 minutes). Try the site yourself; contact your developer if it stays down.
The API crashed / Errors in the API logs	Something failed — often one email that couldn't be delivered. The alert includes the details; forward it to your developer if it repeats.
The API is close to timing out / being throttled	The site was slow or very busy. Usually clears on its own.
The database had errors	A brief problem on Amazon's side. Usually clears on its own.
Too many emails are bouncing	Over 5% of emails bounced — check the Customers page for mistyped addresses.
Unusually many emails sent today	Over 300 emails in a day (normally about 30 a week). Check for something sent twice.

MONTHLY BUDGET

Amazon Web Services emails gtxmeals@gmail.com if the monthly bill is **forecast** to go over **$20**, or **actually** reaches 80% and 100% of it. Normal running costs are well under that.

13. TROUBLESHOOTING

Problem	Try this
A customization doesn't show on a meal	Edit the meal: the add-on's box must have a description or macros (it should say **Offered**). Also check the add-on isn't hidden.
A new add-on shows on no meals	That's expected — fill it in on each meal that should offer it.
A meal isn't on the menu	Check it's available (not hidden) and either a staple or set for the current ready date (shown on the Builder's Ready date card).
Customers say ordering is closed	Check the Builder's Ordering card. Outside Monday 11 AM – Friday 4 PM it's closed unless forced open.
Labels print too small or misaligned	Print from Chrome at 100% / Actual size, Margins: Default. Test on plain paper first.
A customer didn't get an email	Check their email address on the Customers page; ask them to look in spam. Reminders don't go to unsubscribed customers (order emails always do).
A customer wants to change their order after Friday 2 PM	They can't online. Make the change by hand: cancel their order on the Orders page (they'll be emailed) and note the new order, or adjust on prep day.
A customer wants a different pickup location	Set it on the Customers page (Edit → Pickup location). Only you can change it.

Screenshots in this manual use sample data.